

Shortstop has hardest job—Page

Phil Page was watching the Pelicans take infield practice.

"Catching is considered the hardest position to play," said Phil, warming up slowly.

"I claim playing shortstop every day is the hardest. You can give your catcher off days but not your shortstop. In a minor league he almost has to play every game. And it is too much to expect for him to be sharp every game.

"I would like to see it possible in a league of the Southern classification to carry two extra infielders. Then you could give your infielders three or four games off at a time to rest them.



"The shortstop has the hardest plays to make in the infield. He plays more games—if he's a good one—than the other infielders and your catchers."

The conversation changed to the Pelicans' hitting.

"New Orleans is the hottest club we have caught all year," said Phil.

"I have never seen a club in this league hit every ball as solidly as they have in our series in New Orleans and here. They are all stepping up to the plate and cutting. I believe we have caught more line drives off the Pelicans than off any two other clubs."

Andy Cohen was asked when the Pelicans started powdering the ball.

"We starting hitting like you have seen against Chattanooga," said Andy. "Looked like they all broke loose at the same time. And well they did, the streak accounting for 15 wins out of 20 games."